



2008

GLOBAL ECONOMIC CRISIS

Triggered initially by a collapse in the US housing market, the crisis saw banks and financial houses around the developed world unable to meet their commitments. Starting in late 2007, the panic crescendoed with the failure of the Lehman Brothers investment bank the following September, and then spread across much of North America and Europe, causing the most severe economic recession since the Great Depression of the 1930s.

◀ Traders watch as markets tumble

**1961-
BARACK OBAMA**

Born in Hawaii, Obama spent almost four years as a US Senator before winning the Democratic Party nomination for the 2008 Presidential Election. He served two terms in office.

1 August 2008 The South Ossetia War breaks out between Russia and Georgia

8 August 2008 China hosts its first Olympic Games in Beijing

4 November 2008 Barack Obama wins the US Presidential election, becoming the nation's first African-American president

2009

18 May 2009 In Sri Lanka, 26 years of civil conflict comes to an end with the final defeat of Tamil Tiger guerrillas

**10 September 2008
LARGE HADRON COLLIDER
(LHC) COMMISSIONED**

CERN's LHC – the world's largest particle collider – was started up on 10 September 2008. The machine occupies a tunnel 27 km (17 miles) long below the French-Swiss border and allows scientists to accelerate particles to near the speed of light and study the effect of collisions, providing information on the behaviour of the basic building-blocks of the universe.

▷ The Large Hadron Collider

